

Michael Montalbano

Principal Engineer · AI and computer vision, end to end

New York, NY · +1-914-589-4003
montabano1@gmail.com
michaelmontalbano.com · github.com/montabano1
linkedin.com/in/michael-montalbano-47832114

I take systems from an ambiguous problem to production: hardware at customer sites, the models that run on it, and the product people use. I build with fleets of AI coding agents behind hard verification gates, and I report measurements honestly — including the ones that went down.

EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer · Capital One Apr 2025 – Present

- Lead the Account Opening iOS engineering team. “Top Dog” award for championing AI and collaboration across engineering.

E5 Software Engineer, Full Stack · Meta Mar 2020 – Dec 2024

- Built and shipped the Orion AR glasses prototype in C++, Kotlin, and React Native.
- Integrated Ray-Ban Meta glasses, smart glasses, and smartwatches with Meta’s iOS apps for peer-to-peer video calling (React, Objective-C, C++); led the Instagram iOS smartwatch team.

Senior iOS Developer / Project Manager · EarthCam 2019 – 2020

- Oversaw four live-production iOS apps in Swift and Objective-C; cut crash frequency from 4.8% to 0.7% of users.

Math Professor · University of Bridgeport 2011 – 2018

- Designed a placement exam and algorithm that cut initial math-class dropouts by 17%; taught differential equations and multivariable calculus.

PRODUCTS I BUILD

PaddleScreens · founder and sole engineer · paddlescreens.com 2025 – Present

- Court cameras and computer vision for platform tennis at 8 clubs, 900+ match videos: members scan a QR code, play, and get a tracked, analyzed match. Next.js web, Expo mobile, live streaming.
- Wrote the recorder that runs on each Axis camera (C, ACAP) — outbound-only, behind club routers; cutovers refuse to start until every camera checks in and roll back with one flag.
- Vision pipeline: ball tracking (F1 .928 at precision .970), pose, court keypoints, and dual-view 3D flight solving for line calls; moving event detection into 3D added 24–57 points of recall with no new labels.

Beleeg · creator · beleeg.com 2026

- League software (web + mobile) whose Claude copilot takes 43 real actions, each prepared, previewed, and applied only after a person confirms — also exposed as an MCP server under the same rules.
- Default-deny multi-tenant Postgres, Stripe Connect, a live league migrated in; 832 commits in four months, 400+ Playwright tests, 300+ assertions on the write protocol.

RecruitPlan · co-builder · recruitplan.com 2025 – Present

- Built the college lacrosse placement model: a calibrated gradient-boosted classifier on ~34,000 real commitments, replacing a formula that claimed 99% confidence but was right 54–57% of the time (the new one states 62–72%, hits 64–75%).
- Built most of the daily scraping pipelines behind 588 college programs and 62,000 roster players, and the Stripe billing.

Tutorius Math · creator · iOS 2020 – 2023

- SAT and ACT math prep app: 10,000+ downloads in its first year, rated 4.8 on the App Store; custom inline LaTeX rendering, adaptive topic ranking, Firebase and Stripe subscriptions.

SKILLS

Languages	TypeScript, Python, Swift, C++, C, Kotlin, Objective-C, SQL
AI and ML	LLM agents and tool use (Claude), MCP, computer vision, TensorRT, calibrated models, evaluation design
Product stack	React, Next.js, React Native / Expo, Node, Postgres / Supabase, Firebase, GCP, AWS, Stripe
Hardware	Axis cameras (ACAP), edge video, live streaming (RTMP, SRT)

EDUCATION

Bachelor’s in Mathematics
Carnegie Mellon University,
2004 – 2008
Master’s in Math Education
Columbia University, 2009 – 2010